

M Joel Christopher

Doctoral Candidate, Finance & Accounting
Indian Institute of Management Bangalore

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Education

Indian Institute of Management Bangalore

PhD, Finance & Accounting

Advisors: Sankarshan Basu, Abhinav Anand, Nitin Vishen, Pulak Ghosh

CGPA: 3.44/4

2021-2026

Indian Institute of Technology Madras

Executive MBA, General Management & Finance

CGPA: 8.97/10

2019-2020

National Institute of Technology Tiruchirappalli

B.Tech, Production Engineering

CGPA: 9.03/10

2008-2012

Research Interests

Banking, Financial Intermediation, Corporate Finance, Financial Markets, Investments

Research

Job Market Paper

Banking Against the Odds: Performance and Lending Efficiency of Government Banks during Crisis (*co-authored with Sankarshan Basu, Abhinav Anand, and Nitin Vishen*)

Government-owned banks are often inefficient but can stabilize economies during downturns. Using difference-in-differences analyses of Indian banks during a nationwide economic crisis, we show that government-owned banks expanded lending, especially in severely impacted regions. However, contrary to prior literature, these banks outperformed private banks in terms of stock market returns by significantly improving profitability as well as lending quality. We attribute this improvement in performance to pre-pandemic policy interventions, including the adoption of digital banking and regulator-driven balance sheet clean-ups, which enabled sustainable counter-cyclical lending. Non-banking activities, deposit growth, and bank mergers do not explain the observed increases in lending and profitability. Cross-country analyses of the same global shock show that greater government ownership of banking assets is associated with larger lending increases and, conditional on pre-crisis loan-quality improvements, higher post-crisis profitability. (*Target: The Review of Financial Studies*)

Working Papers

Does Alignment Between Federal and Local Governments Affect Corporate Lending? *(co-authored with Sankarshan Basu, Abhinav Anand, and Nitin Vishen)*

Studies the impact of federal political alignment on bank lending and credit allocation.

Do Sustainability Disclosure Mandates Affect Bank Lending? Evidence from BRSR Implementation in India *(co-authored with Ruchi Vohra, and Meena Poola)*

Examines how BRSR disclosure requirements influence firm credit access and loan terms.

Monetary Policy Transmission Across Regime Shifts: Evidence from Bank Lending Channels *(co-authored with Rohith Devaram)*

Analyzes how monetary policy transmission varies across regimes, with implications for bank lending and credit allocation.

Conference Presentations

FMA Annual Meeting, Vancouver	2025
Modern Finance Conference, Warsaw	2025
Vietnam Symposium in Entrepreneurship, Finance, & Innovation, Hanoi	2025

Teaching Experience

Instructor

Course	Level	Course Evaluation
Applied R for Econometrics	Predoc / PhD	4.90/5
Finance & Accounting	Undergraduate	4.90/5
R for Data Science	Postgraduate	4.63/5
Applied R for Econometrics	Predoc / PhD	4.60/5

Teaching Assistant

Course	Faculty	TA Feedback
Corporate Finance	Dr. Shashidhar Murthy	Excellent
Corporate Finance	Dr. Anirudh Dhawan	Excellent
Global Securities Markets	Dr. Sankarshan Basu	Excellent
Risk Management	Dr. Sankarshan Basu	Excellent
Investments	Dr. Sumit Saurav	Excellent
Financial Derivatives	Dr. Shashidhar Murthy	Very Good

Other Voluntary Teaching & Pedagogy Development

Course	Level
Intro to R	Predoc
Asset Pricing Theory	PhD
Financial Mathematics	Undergraduate

Programs Conducted

Academic Associates Sensitization Program (IIM Bangalore)

Research Recognition

Best Paper Award, IIT Madras	2026
Best Paper Award, IFMR GSB, KREA University	2026
Mirae Asset Scholar Award, IIM Bangalore	2025
Best Paper Award, IIT Kharagpur	2025
Best Paper Award, IFMR GSB, KREA University	2025
Best Paper Award (Runner-Up), IIM Indore	2025
Black Rock Award (Shortlisted), IIM Vishakapatnam	2025

Industry Experience

Indian Railways	2015 – 2021
<i>Senior Section Engineer (General Management)</i>	
Supported senior administrative leadership in managing large-scale railway operations	

Balmer Lawrie & Co. Ltd.	2012 – 2015
<i>Assistant Manager (Manufacturing)</i>	
Managed production operations within a profit centre environment	

Industry Recognition

Railway Week Award	2019
Award for Analytical Skills and Professionalism	2018

Technical Skills

R, Stata, Python, SAS, SPSS, L^AT_EX

Training & Workshops

Institution	Program	Year
IIM Bangalore	Doctoral Consortium on Teaching	2025
IIM Bangalore	Winter Research Methodology Workshop	2024
IIM Kozhikode	Advanced Certificate in Academic Research & Data Analysis	2023
IIFT Kolkata	Structural Equation Modelling & Systematic Literature Review	2023
IIT Bombay	Research Approaches & Methods in Management, Social Sciences & Education	2022
JIMS Kalkaji	Advanced Econometrics & Data Analytics using R	2022

Additional Information

Experience in equity and derivatives trading; portfolio management and investment analysis.

References

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